

ស្វាគមន៍! (som sva skom)

WELCOME TO CAMBODIA

GUIDE FOR SHORT TERM TEAMS



Serve the community,
educate youth, develop
leaders, & train professionals

Welcome to your adventure with YWAM Siem Reap!

Thank you for your YES, and your heart for Cambodia. We believe that God has a purpose for your time here.

At YWAM Siem Reap, we are passionate about seeing lives transformed through the love of Jesus. As a short-term outreach team, you have the incredible opportunity to serve alongside us in local villages, schools, churches, and communities, sharing the Gospel in both word and action.

Siem Reap is a city rich in history, culture, and resilience. While known for the stunning Angkor Wat temple, it is also home to many who have never heard the name of Jesus. Your time here will not only impact lives, but we pray it will deepen your faith, challenge you, and equip you for a life of mission—wherever God calls you next.

This booklet will provide you with all the essential information for your outreach: practical guidelines, cultural insights, ministry opportunities, and ways to prepare spiritually for your time in Cambodia.

We are honored to walk this journey with you and can't wait to see how God moves through your team. Welcome to YWAM Siem Reap—let's make Jesus known together!

Blessings,

YWAM Siem Reap family 

A person in a crowd is holding up a pair of white sneakers high above their head. The background is dark and out of focus, suggesting a large gathering or event. The text is overlaid on the image.

**“Airplanes were
invented for
missionaries to
complete the Great
Commission”**

**Loren Cunningham,
YWAM Founder**

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YWAM CAMBODIA MISSION & VISION

ONE NATION ONE GENERATION

At YWAM Cambodia, we are committed to seeing Cambodia transformed in one generation through the power of the Gospel. Our mission is to serve communities, educate youth, and develop leaders who will bring lasting change to the nation.

10 IN 10

82% of Cambodia are Buddhist and only 2% Christians. While the church is growing, millions have yet to hear the gospel. We believe God is moving powerfully. Over the next 10 years, we're praying and working to see the Christian population grow to 10%—as more Cambodians meet Jesus, make disciples, and plant churches.





1 50+ Staff

UofN Poipet and UofN Siem Reap are cross-cultural campuses overseeing more than 20 ministries across both cities. Together, we function as a unified family, comprising over 50 staff members from diverse backgrounds and nationalities, committed to serving the community and fostering transformation.

2 Locations

In 2024, UofN Poipet established a pioneering team in Siem Reap, Cambodia, expanding its mission and impact. This strategic collaboration fosters synergy between both bases, enabling mutual support, resource sharing, and the exchange of innovative ideas to advance Kingdom work throughout Cambodia.

3 One Family 4 One Goal

With a diverse range of backgrounds and two operating languages on base, we prioritize unity in pursuing a shared mission. By working together as one family, we overcome challenges and celebrate victories as a community. **Welcome to the family!**

"One Nation, One Generation." This shared vision unites the UofN Cambodia family as we dedicate ourselves to transforming this nation for God within a single generation.

OUR MINISTRIES

SERVE THE COMMUNITY

We serve the community through Gon Preah (child of God) Café, providing a safe space for high school students and a place to share Jesus, and GP Education, offering free primary education to underprivileged children and through outreach teams



DEVELOP LEADERS

Through DTS, DBS, and School of Ministry Development, we disciple the next generation of Cambodian leaders, helping them find their identity in Christ and their purpose in the world.



EDUCATE YOUTH

Our Youth Development Center (YDC) equips high school students with English skills, while our media ministry reaches over 15 million Cambodians monthly with inspiring content.



TRAIN PROFESSIONALS

We train and equip Khmer youth in skills like technical, music, multimedia, hospitality, culinary, finance, cafe, and education

Through these initiatives, we seek to **transform** Cambodia by **empowering** the next generation of Christian leaders and serving the community holistically—spiritually, educationally, and socially.

MOVEMENT

GON PREAH

**GP MOVEMENT EMPOWERS GEN Z
CAMBODIANS TO DISCOVER THEIR
IDENTITY & PURPOSE, RAISING UP
THE NEXT GENERATION OF KHMER
LEADERS**

GP INITIATIVES >>>

GP EDUCATION

GP CAFE

GP PLANNER/MERCH

GP DTS



GON PREAH is a khmer phrase meaning "Child of God."

The GON PREAH Movement (GP MVMT) is a
MULTIFACETED ministry dedicated to revealing the
truthful identity of Jesus to the youth of Cambodia. We
are committed to showing aspects of the lifestyle of
freedom that Jesus died for THROUGH THE CREATION
OF A MULTIFACETED BRAND.



ywampoipet.org/gped



HOW TEAMS SERVE

There are many ways that teams can serve in:

1 SHARING THE GOSPEL

There will be many opportunities to share the love of Jesus and bring the gospel to the unreached. Teams bring hope through testimonies, house visits in the villages, and youth events.

2 SUPPORTING MINISTRIES

Teams support the ministries that we partner with in Siem Reap working in areas like education, children's ministry, food distribution, and construction.

3 SKILLS

Those with experience in worship, media, barista skills, kitchen, and technical skills can empower and inspire our staff while supporting various ministries.

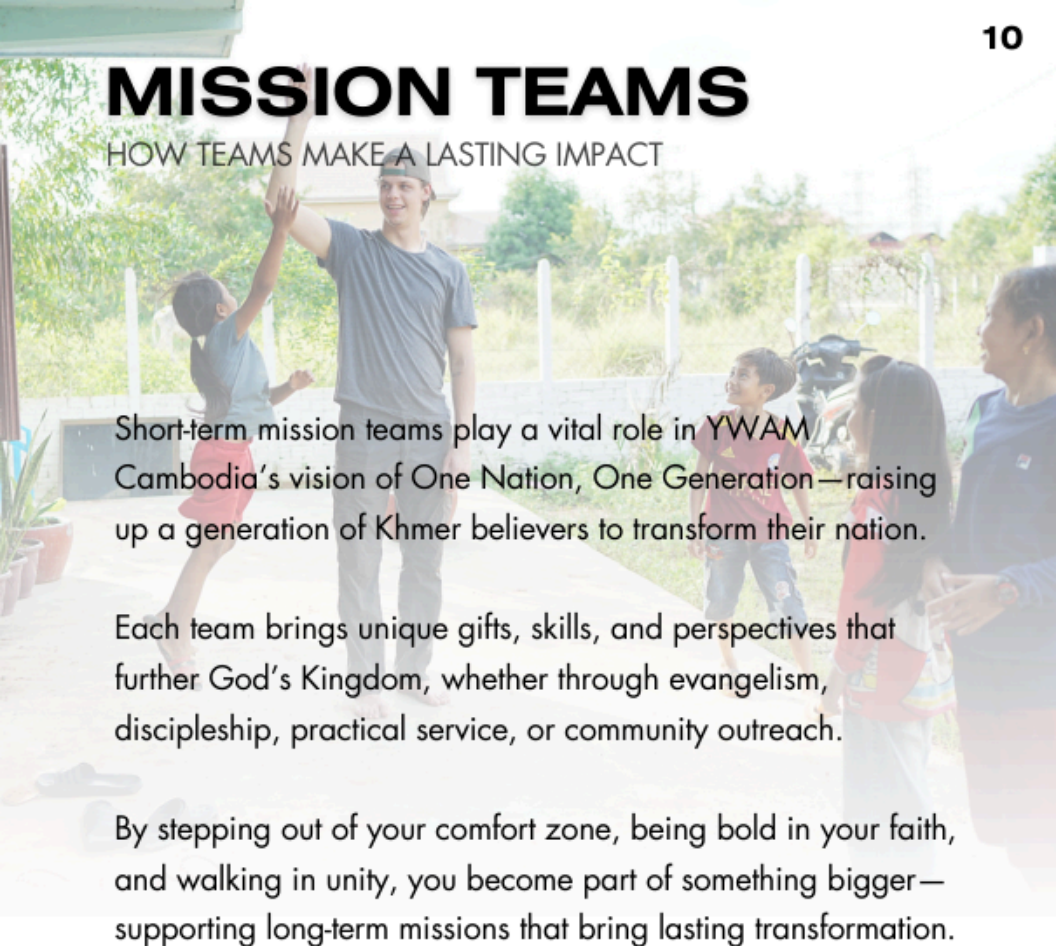
4 ENCOURAGING & SUPPORTING MISSIONARIES

Teams work along side our staff bringing fresh energy, prayer and support to those serving in long term missions. By building lasting relationships, they encourage long-term missionaries in Cambodia through ongoing prayer and financial support.



MISSION TEAMS

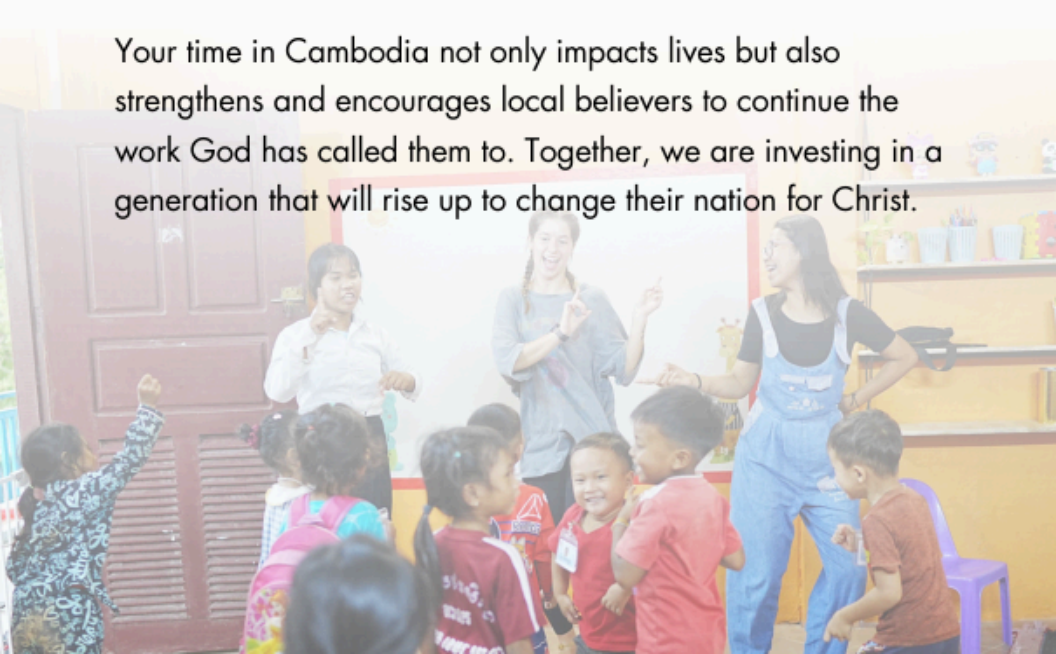
HOW TEAMS MAKE A LASTING IMPACT



Short-term mission teams play a vital role in YWAM Cambodia's vision of One Nation, One Generation—raising up a generation of Khmer believers to transform their nation.

Each team brings unique gifts, skills, and perspectives that further God's Kingdom, whether through evangelism, discipleship, practical service, or community outreach.

By stepping out of your comfort zone, being bold in your faith, and walking in unity, you become part of something bigger—supporting long-term missions that bring lasting transformation.



Your time in Cambodia not only impacts lives but also strengthens and encourages local believers to continue the work God has called them to. Together, we are investing in a generation that will rise up to change their nation for Christ.



BEFORE THE TRIP

SPIRITUAL & PRACTICAL PREPARATION



WORSHIP & PRAYER

Your journey starts with prayer. Worship and prayer are powerful tools of spiritual warfare, bringing unity, strength, and guidance. They prepare your heart and mind for the path ahead, equipping you for what's to come.



MINISTRY PREP

Take time to reflect on your faith and how your journey led you to believe. Be ready to share your story—your testimony has the power to uplift, encourage, and bring life to those you meet. Come prepared with songs, dances, skits, and games—these are some of the best ways to connect with the Khmer people and build meaningful relationships.



CULTURE, LANGUAGE, & AWARENESS

Learning about the culture and a few basic phrases in the language shows respect and helps you connect with people. Take time to explore Cambodia's history and traditions—this will deepen your understanding and appreciation of the Khmer people.



SET THE RIGHT MINDSET

Come with a heart to serve. Remember, as a short-term team, you are here to support long-term missions. Things may not always go as planned, so be FAT—Flexible, Adaptable, and Teachable!



BEFORE THE TRIP

SPIRITUAL & PRACTICAL PREPARATION



PACKING ESSENTIALS

- Shoes (bring shoes that you don't mind getting dirty) & sandals
- Bedding and pillows are provided but towels are not! Make sure to bring towels for your trip.
- Water Bottle– Hydration is important as it gets pretty spicy here
- Sunscreen! Lots of it! (Cambodia can get pretty toasty so sunscreen is a for sure necessity)
- Personal toiletry items (Cambodia is limited to the brand of soap and other products you are familiar with)
- Mosquito spray– they can get pretty savage especially during rainy season. Mosquito spray is also available to buy in country!
- Raincoat (depending on the season, there is a lot of rainfall in Cambodia)
- Passport (must be valid at least 6 months before arrival)

CULTURAL DO'S & DONT'S

Feet

In Cambodia, be careful with your feet! Do not show the bottoms of your feet when sitting, as they are the lowest part of the body and represent dirtiness. When sitting, try to sit in a kneeling position or criss-cross! (Note: when entering households, take off your shoes. This is Asia! In some cases, take off your shoes at shops!)

Heads

Just as the feet are the lowest part of the body and represent dirtiness- the head is the highest part of the body and closest to God (representing knowledge and something to be respected). Please refrain from touching peoples heads. Note: remove your hats when entering a household, or when in a room where someone is teaching.

Monks

It's not everyday that you see a monk walking around! You are welcome to speak with the monks you see and build relationship. (Note: Please be respectful and do not touch the monks. For example, if a monk is touched by a woman - even if just on the shoulder- the monk will have to go through a week-long purification).



Generosity

Cambodia is a nation of generosity! Don't be surprised when you are invited to sit down and eat with the Khmer various times throughout the day! Generosity is a love language here, so learn to get comfortable with accepting their generosity! We also encourage you to share the food you have with the Khmer, as this will be something to bond over!

Pagodas (TEMPLES)

Feel free to visit Pagoda's with at least one other person but please be respectful and represent Jesus and U of N Cambodia well. Don't go after dark. Pray before and during and after you visit. Please wear very modest clothing and be respectful.

Inviting

When you invite people out (which you should often) you are expected to pay. If you are invited, this does not mean we should assume they are paying, always offer to pay.



CULTURAL DO'S & DONT'S

Children

You may see children being treated differently than in your home country. Remember to respect Cambodian culture and ask questions to your ministry contact when needed. It is ok to touch young children's heads, just be mindful. Please check before taking photos and posting online. Kid's are not a museum.

Money

Please don't carry large amounts of money. You don't need to carry your passports around the city... put them in a safe place (suitcases, cabinets, etc). Please do not give money to the beggars/children: this encourages them to keep begging. Offer to buy a bottle of water or a small snack, but do not give money.

Physical Touch

Touch is very common in Cambodia. Men touch men. Women touch women. You will see men holding hands with men and find women with their arms around each other. These examples are of friendship, not sexual. Touching the opposite sex is not appropriate in public.

Evangelism

It's all about relationships in Cambodia! Get to know the person a few times and then they trust and value what you are talking about. Want to open the door to share the gospel with someone – create a relationship! Ask open-ended questions. Yes or No questions are not a good way to gauge what people really feel or believe

Examples: What do you think about that? How does that make you feel?

LAWS ABOUT EVANGELISM:

If a religious gathering (open air preaching) is too loud the authorities can shut it down as well as our organization. You cannot speak negatively about Buddhism or other religions— respect is important in Cambodia. You cannot force people to stop going to the Pagoda to worship Buddha. Please don't go into a Temple with the goal of evangelism.



CULTURAL DO'S & DONT'S

Clothing

Most of the clothes you need during ministry time should be semi-professional. During non-ministry times (including weekends when outside of the house) your clothing should still be appropriate.

Remember, "Modest is hottest".

Girls

Teaching:

Skirts are best for teaching, with a nice shirt or button-up

Ministry when not teaching:

Jeans, tidy long pants and capris are ok if they go past the knees (even when sitting). Please don't wear Thai/Elephant pants for ministry. T-shirts are ok.

For ministries involving sports or outdoor/dirty work:

shorts are allowed but must be long basketball shorts going to the knees. No short running shorts please. T-shirts are ok

Out of ministry hours:

t-shirts are great, long basketball shorts or any pants are ok

Swimming:

Khmer women usually wear basketball shorts and t-shirts so we do this too

NOTE: Please make sure V-neck t-shirts aren't loose in the front when you bend down. Dresses and skirts should go below the knees or can be worn with leggings. Leggings should never be worn as the top layer. In your room you can wear whatever you like!

Boys

Teaching:

long pants (slacks not jeans), a tidy polo or button-up shirt

Ministry when not teaching:

Jeans, tidy long pants or tidy shorts to the knees. T-shirts are ok

For ministries involving sports or outdoor/dirty work:

shorts are allowed but must be long basketball shorts going almost to the knees. Please don't wear Thai/Elephant pants for ministry. T-shirts are great

Out of ministry hours:

t-shirts are great, long basketball shorts or any pants are ok

Swimming:

Swimming shorts/trunks to the knee



CULTURAL DO'S & DONT'S

Clothing

Most of the clothes you need during ministry time should be semi-professional. During non-ministry times (including weekends when outside of the house) your clothing should still be appropriate.

Remember, "Modest is hottest".

Both:

Piercings:

Men – no piercings in while you are in Cambodia, Women – please have only ear piercings in while in Cambodia, or small stud piercings in nose

Tattoos:

Please don't call attention to your tattoos. Some ministries will ask you to wear long sleeve shirts or long pants/skirts to cover tattoos. We ask that you don't get new tattoos or piercings while on outreach.

- Please don't wear Thai/Elephant pants for ministry.

- Please refrain from wearing pajamas or basketball shorts downstairs during work hours (even if you are taking a sick day).
- While it is hot, it is good to have a few long sleeve shirts for going out. It sounds weird, but it will actually be cooler because you don't have the sun hitting your skin directly. You may want to purchase a few UV long-sleeve shirts as these are comfortable and can be worn for ministry at certain places.

Please respect our dress code even on the day you are leaving Siem Reap

Time in Cambodia

- A majority of Cambodians will never be on time. On average expect them to be late.
- Cambodians will always choose relationship over time so that means they will finish the conversation they are having even if it makes them late to the next thing
- If you want a Cambodian or anyone for that matter to show up on time, tell them the amount of time you will be free, EG "I will be free from 2-3 because I have a meeting at 3, can we meet then?"
- Respect yours and others time, by being on time and preparing for ministries beforehand as much as possible

**Our home is your home!
We ask that you would help
us steward this base well!**

✓ Mealtimes

"Nyum bai howie nou?" The famous Khmer one-liner meaning "Have you eaten yet?" Mealtimes here at YWAM Siem Reap are easy! Every week day and Sunday night, the base provides **breakfast (7:30am), lunch (12:30pm), and dinner (6:30pm)**! At these times, you will hear a bell ring so you know when to come down to eat! Mealtimes are held outside on the fridge. If you plan to be eating a meal off of base, be sure to notify your outreach coordinator so that the kitchen staff is aware and can plan accordingly. Same applies with inviting guests to our base during our mealtimes!

✓ Room Care

Our rooms are your place to unwind and relax after a day of ministry! There are a few things we would like to let you know to help steward this place well:

- No toilet paper down the toilets! (the sewage systems in Cambodia cannot handle it)
- No shoes in the bedrooms! (Please keep your shoes in the shoe room before you enter the base!)
- Lights and AC turned off if you are the last person to leave the room! (As noted above, please keep AC units above 22 degrees!)
- No bringing or eating food in rooms.

✓ Quiet Hours

This base is not only a hub of amazing ministries, but houses long-term staff and families with children. Because of this, we want to honor yours and the staffs' sleeping schedules.

Quiet hours are from 9:30pm - 7:30am.

The gate will also lock at 9:30pm. If you are going to be late, make sure you let someone on base know so that you aren't locked out. Just be mindful the later you're out, the later the person locking up has to stay up. Make sure to honor the ones locking the gate.

**Our home is your home!
We ask that you would help
us steward this base well!**

✓ **Operating Vehicles**

Outreach teams are not allowed to operate any vehicles including, cars, motos, and tractors. You are however able to operate bicycles. When riding passenger on the moto, make sure to wear a helmet.

✓ **Stewardship**

YWAM Siem Reap is a fun, joyful community filled with games, cafe, and various places to converse & study! We want to ask that you help us to steward these places well! When leaving any area, check to see if there is any trash or mess that needs tending to. When using any of the rooms, please do your due diligence to turn off AC's and lights before you go! When using the kitchen, make sure to clean up after yourself.

In your rooms-

We love the blessing of air conditioners after a day of serving in the sun! When back - be sure to keep AC units at 22 degrees and above! Anything below 22 degrees doesn't change the room much but it does cause the cost of the electricity to skyrocket! With that, please be sure that individual bed lights, room lights and AC units are turned off when you leave your dorm room. We have a staff member that does daily rooms checks. If there are dorm rooms with AC, bed lights, or room lights left on, **BEWARE!** Those room members will be cleaning dishes that night/the whole week! Let's take care of our base together!

✓ **Drinking & Smoking**

Drinking, smoking/vaping are not allowed on base or out.

DURING THE TRIP

EMBRACING CULTURAL RESPECT AND UNDERSTANDING



Relational:

Cambodians value relationships above all else. Their culture is deeply relational, centered on building connections, trust, and genuine friendships. Taking the time to get to know one another is essential and often more important than tasks or schedules

Faithful:

Faithfulness is a powerful act of spiritual warfare. Stay faithful in the small things, because when you are faithful with little, you will be entrusted with much. Every act of faithfulness strengthens your walk and advances God's Kingdom.

Passivity:

God has brought you here for a purpose. Don't be afraid to step beyond your comfort zone—growth happens in the moments of discomfort. Make the most of your time here, go all in, and be bold in your faith!

Food & Culture:

Remember, you are in Cambodia—embrace the culture with an open heart and mind. You'll encounter new foods, unfamiliar scents, and unique experiences, but each one is an opportunity to learn and grow. Cambodia's rich history and beautiful culture are worth exploring, so step in with curiosity and appreciation!

សៀមរាប

OUR CITY: SIEM REAP

៛ 4,000៛ = \$1

Here in Siem Reap, there are two currencies that are commonly used: Khmer Riel (៛) and USD (\$) **4,000**

KHR = 1 USD is the classic

exchange rate. Want to exchange your money? **Look for "Wing"** -

exchange booths set up all across the nation. Look for the green logo, and make sure your bills are **NOT** wrinkled or ripped as they will likely not accept if they are in bad condition.

Wing



Hungry?

Yes, YWAM Siem Reap provides meals on the weekdays and Sunday nights, but sometimes you might need a little pick-me-up! We recommend heading to the street vendors for a cheap, tasty snack! (Helpful tip: ask the Khmer staff on base for food recommendations!)



Explore

Siem Reap is a vibrant city with bustling markets and warm hearts! You will have downtime and we encourage you to explore our city - find new cafes, try new snacks, go shopping at the night market, there are so many things to do!



Tuktuk!

Hop on your phone and go to the App/Play Store to download the application, "PassApp" or "Grab"! It's an app that you will use often in our city! (**Think Uber but in Southeast Asian tuktuk style!**). This app is helpful for your grocery runs, going to church, and other errands/duties you need to do! A typical ride ranges between 4,000 - 10,000 KHR (\$1-\$2.50). Note: PassApp you will need a khmer number but not for Grab.

PRACTICAL INFO



TIMEZONE IN SIEM REAP:

Cambodia is in the Indochina Time Zone (ICT)

SEASONS:

Dry Season: Typically from November to April, this period features dry weather and warm temperatures. November-February is the peak tourist

season, with low humidity and minimal rainfall. However, March and April can be very hot, with temperatures reaching up to 42 degrees Celsius.

Rainy Season:

Lasting from May to October, this season brings heavy rainfall (mostly only 1-2 hours/d) and higher humidity. Despite the intense rain, it results in lush green landscapes, making it appealing for some travelers to visit.

AIRPORTS:

Siem Reap Angkor International Airport (SAI) > about one hour to Siem Reap.

\$25 -> 4 passenger car

\$30 -> 12 passenger van

\$35 -> 15 passenger van

VISAS & HOUSING:

Ask teams coordinator for more info :)

VACCINATIONS:

Hepatitis B, Up to date Tetanus, and Typhoid are required

MEET THE TEAM

YWAM Siem Reap



ITH KETH

DTS STAFF



RANIE

DTS STAFF



TINH THEAN

MEDIA & GP MUSIC



BEN WRIGHT

FINANCE & GP MUSIC



KIMLA SONG

HOSPITALITY & MEDIA



YANG & SREYLEAK

DTS & DBS STAFF



YI & ESTHER

HOSPITALITY & TECHNICAL



NALL BEE

MEDIA



VICHET CHEA

DTS STAFF & YDC

MEET THE TEAM

YWAM Siem Reap



DAVID

WORSHIP & DTS STAFF



CHENLEN

TECHNICAL



NO EH

DTS STAFF



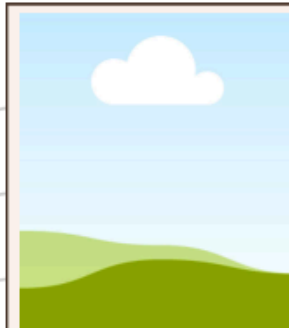
SOPHY

WORSHIP & DTS STAFF



VANNAK

DTS STAFF



KAMI MARTZ

GP MUSIC



EMMY

TEAMS & YDC



TYLER

HOSPITALITY & YDC



ALEXIS MUNOS

DBS & TEAMS

MEET THE TEAM

yWAM Siem Reap



URIAH & NAOMI LYFORD

BASE DIRECTOR



CHANYA BUT

BASE LEADER & GP MUSIC



SININ SOK

TRAINING DIRECTOR
& BASE LEADER



ANDREW & NAOMIE LEE

BASE LEADER



SREYLEAK RANN

BASE LEADER



SREYNIT THORN

DTS STAFF & BASE LEADER

KHMER SUPPORT

Invest in the next generation of Khmer missionaries

MEET YANG & SREYLEAK

Yang and Sreyleak are a passionate Cambodian couple serving in Siem Reap since January 2025. With a heart for discipling Khmer youth, they help young people discover their identity in Christ and purpose in life.

They staff DTS and DBS, investing in future leaders through teaching, mentorship, and discipleship.

Currently living on \$225/month, they are believing for \$600/month to sustain their ministry and continue impacting Cambodia for God's Kingdom.



Give to Yang & Sreyleak

MEET YI & ESTHER TUOT

and Molika

The Tuot family serves faithfully with YWAM in Siem Reap. Yi and Esther are passionate about equipping others through education, hospitality, and technical ministries—regularly traveling for teacher training.

Esther is also pursuing her passion for art to inspire and teach others. Their vision is to launch a kids' ministry school next year to help children grow in faith and learning.

With their 9-month-old daughter Molika, they currently live on \$300/month and are trusting God to raise \$600/month to continue their ministry. Your support can help impact the next generation in Cambodia.



Give to Yi & Esther

KHMER SUPPORT

Invest in the next generation of Khmer missionaries



Give to Kimla

MEET KIMLA

Kimla is a young Cambodian on fire for Jesus! After completing his Discipleship Training School (DTS) in 2024, he began his commitment with YWAM Siem Reap in January 2025, pursuing his passion for media and hospitality.

With a heart to reach youth through social media and a deep desire to serve others well, he is dedicated to using his gifts to share the love of Christ in Cambodia. To continue his ministry, he is believing for \$200 in monthly support. Your partnership would help empower him to impact lives through media and hospitality!

KHMER SUPPORT

Invest in the next generation of Khmer missionaries

HOW TO INVEST?

Click on the link if you feel led to give





UNIVERSITY OF THE NATIONS CAMBODIA

After the Khmer Rouge regime, YWAM served in refugee camps on the Thai border in the 1980s. In 1991, Cambodia welcomed foreign aid, leading to the establishment of YWAM Cambodia under Philip and Wendy Scott. Initially focused on medical care, community development, English teaching, and church planting in Stung Treng, YWAM expanded in 2000 with a Phnom Penh team hosting short-term teams and training Cambodian youth. This led to the University of the Nations Cambodia (UofN), officially registered in 2002.

Since then, YWAM Cambodia has grown to include ministries for at-risk children, dormitory and education programs, and training centers in English, media, arts, and office skills. Today, over 200 staff serve across 16 locations in 10 provinces, including key centers in Koh Kong, Pailin, Poipet, Battambang, and recently in Siem Reap

